



SuperGaming Case Study



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Problem 1: How would you position Indus to win in India and find relevance globally?



Context & Why It Matters

Battle Royale is one of mobile gaming's most crowded genres, dominated by global giants (Free Fire, BGMI/PUBG) that lack strong cultural resonance in India.

Indus, with its unique Indo-futuristic aesthetic needs a sustainable differentiator that wins hearts locally and intrigues players globally.

Moving beyond character skins, we must create cultural authenticity, community ownership, and a living meta-system that keeps all player types engaged- and proud to say they play "India's own Battle Royale."



Strategic Approach

I follow a Persona-Driven → Differentiator → Roadmap → Metrics framework to ensure every recommendation serves real players and delivers measurable impact.

Define & Deeply Understand User Personas

Persona	Description	Core Motivation
Core Shooter (M 18–35)	Competitive, 30–60 min/day on FPS; values performance & mastery	Skill expression, status, national pride
Aspirational Gamer (F 18–30)	Women who want safe, empowering spaces	Representation, social belonging, role models
Casual Explorer (25–40)	Plays <30 min/day; loves story, social sharing with friends	Narrative, ease of entry, cultural connection

Single High-Leverage Differentiator: "Made in India" Authenticity + Influencer Co-Creation

Indus isn't just themed around India—it's built in India, and stamped with a national pride that no other BR can match.

What This Differentiator Looks Like in Action



Official "Made in India" Launch Campaign

Government & Platform Tie-Ins: Leverage the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative and Google Play's "Made in India" section.

Store Presence: Prominent "Made in India" badge, "Built in India" developer diary videos showcasing the Hyderabad studio.

Narrative Launch Video: Short film weaving modern technology with ancient Indian motifs, shared across TikTok, YouTube, and Instagram.



Anchor Partnership with Indian Influencer - Payal Gaming

Payal's Royal Legacy Crate Opening Event: Invite Payal to stream opening a ₹1 Lakh-value in-game crate filled with rare cosmetics and lore collectibles.

Live "Payal vs. Fans" Community Showdowns: Weekly custom matches filmed and broadcast on YouTube/Twitch, with real-time overlays and live chat integration.



Creator-Driven Seasonal Factions

Faction Selection UI: At each season's start, players choose between Payal's Vanguard or Shadow Legion (led by a top male streamer - Jonathan).

Daily & Weekly Faction Quests: Simple missions (e.g., "Earn 500 XP for Vanguard today") that earn faction points.

Tiered Faction Rewards:

- Bronze Tier: Faction banners + small XP boosters,
- Silver Tier: Payal-voiced victory emote + faction badge,
- Gold Tier: Exclusive Payal's Vanguard weapon skin + "Made in India" crate effect.

This structure appeals: Core Shooters chase leaderboard status and exclusive gold-tier rewards. Aspirational Gamers join Payal's Vanguard for representation and community pride. Casual Explorers enjoy visible lore progression and social bragging rights.

Execution Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundations (Weeks 0-2)

- Integrate Google Play "Made in India" badge
- Publish "Built in India" dev diaries
- Announce Payal partnership

Phase 3: Faction Alpha Launch (Weeks 7-10)

- Launch faction pledge UI & backend flags
- Implement point tracking & leaderboards
- Deploy tiered faction rewards

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Phase 2: Crate MVP (Weeks 3-6)

- Host Payal's Crate Opening Event streams
- Instrument crate analytics
 - Check purchase distribution for crate types
 - Check impact on ARPU

Phase 4: Dynamic World Hooks & Scale (Weeks 11-14)

- Use remote-config to apply faction map skins
- Run mid-season "double points" weekends
- Localize campaigns (Hindi, Tamil, English)

Strategic Summary

By centering on “**Made in India**” authenticity and **co-creating with Payal Gaming**, Indus leverages a **sustainable competitive moat** that:

1. **Drives Local Pride & Discovery:** Government and store initiatives boost organic installs.
2. **Builds Community & Representation:** Factions and female-led co-creation engage under-served audiences.
3. **Fuels Engagement & Retention:** Daily quests, tiered rewards, and dynamic map visuals keep all personas invested.
4. **Scales Globally:** A fresh, culturally rich IP intrigues international gamers seeking new universes.

This **persona-driven, phased roadmap** ensures measurable impact at every step, positioning Indus as **India’s premier Battle Royale**—a title built for the world, rooted in our culture, and powered by community creativity.

Problem 2: Retention and monetization beyond Day 7 are low for MaskGun



Context & Why It Matters:

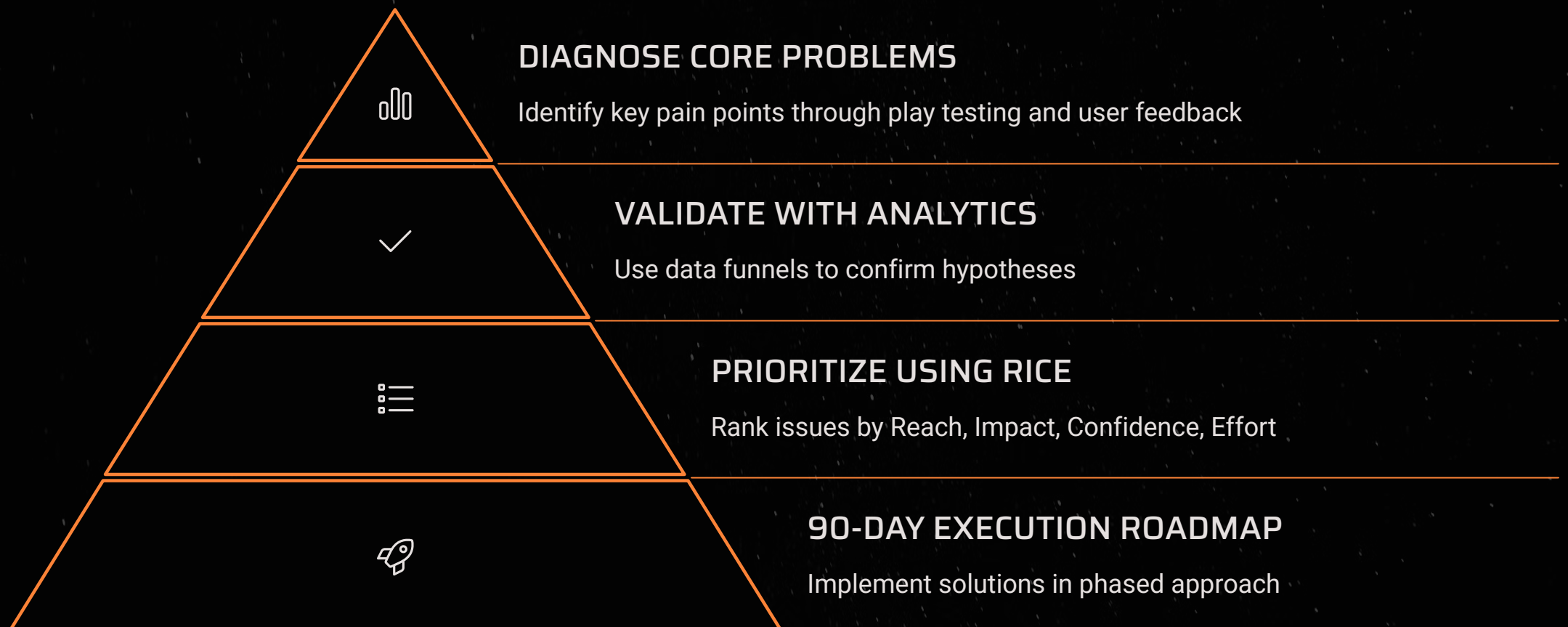
MaskGun is a polished 5v5 mobile shooter with strong install volumes and great core gameplay feedback-but retention beyond Day 7 sits low, Users churn or become inactive despite new map drops and occasional events.

This drop-off starves our live-ops funnel, stalling monetization. To sustain growth, we must stop the leak in engagement first, then re-ignite monetization.



Overall Framework:

I'll drive a 4-step turnaround: Diagnose → Validate → Prioritize → Execute, ensuring each fix targets the true churn drivers, is proven by data, and is rolled out in a rapid, phased roadmap.



Key Pain-Points Identified in MaskGun



Server Verification Hangs:

Players get stuck before matches start, causing frustration.



Control Customization Friction:

Custom layouts are not introduced early, causing churn for non-customizers.



Opaque Progression & Hidden Missions:

Weapon unlocks and achievements are poorly surfaced, reducing motivation.



Ammo Dead-Ends:

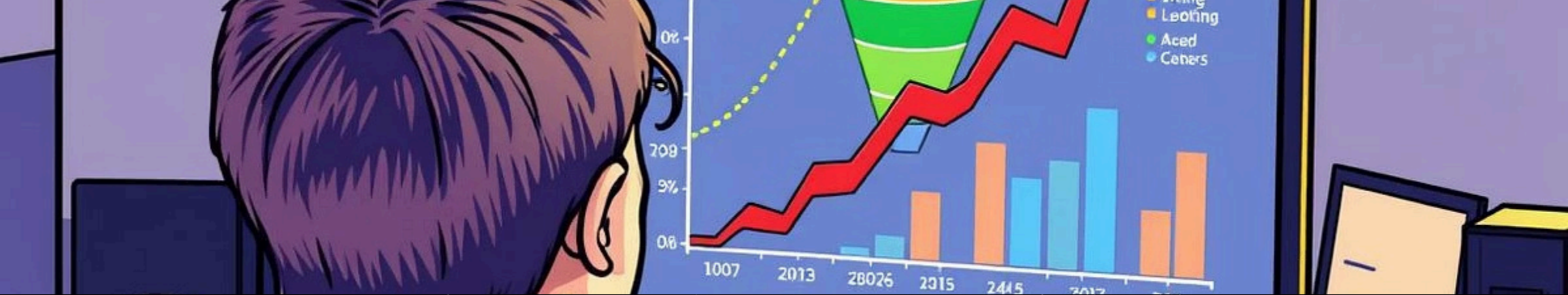
Running out of ammo without restock forces deaths, disrupting gameplay.



Short Login Reward Cadence:

7-day calendar ends quickly, lacking long-term player incentives.





Validate Pain Points Using Analytics Funnels

1 Server Errors:

Flag error rate above 5% from connection errors during match load.

- Match_Load_Start → Connection_Error → Match_Exit

2 Ammo Dead-Ends:

Over 20% match exits or deaths after ammo depletion suggest restock needed.

- Ammo_Depleted → (Restock_Ammo OR Weapon_Swapped) vs. Match_Exit OR Death

3 Control Customization:

Total number of reviewers that have complained about control customization vs total number of reviewers. Anything above 15% is a validation for the same

4 Login Reward Test:

Multivariate tests for 7day, 15day and 30day login rewards, check for D7, D15 and D30 metrics post test.

5 Missions Completion:

Below 25% completion means mission UI should be more visible.

- Login → Open_Missions_UI → Complete_Mission → Claim_Reward

6 Progression Clarity:

Less than 30% progressing to view unlock indicates UI/UX issues.

- Level_Up → Open_Progress_UI → View_Next_Unlock

Prioritization of MaskGun Issues Using RICE Framework

Issue	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	Priority	Reason
Server hangs	High	Very High	Medium	Medium	🚩 P0	This is a blocker issue and could cause a lot of drop offs, if its very frequent
Ammo dead-ends	High	Medium	Medium	Medium	🚩 P0	Prevents the most common hard churn triggers, immediately boosting retention.
Login reward test	High	High	High	Medium	🚩 P1	Longer calendars build habit loops
Control customization friction	High	Medium	High	Medium	🚩 P1	This came up in reviews for the game and if quantified, would be an easy fix
Progression clarity	Medium	High	Low	Low	🚩 P2	Clear goals improve motivation - directly improves Day 7+ retention
Missions/Achievements hidden	Medium	Medium	Low	Low	🚩 P2	Low effort surface-level change - provides immediate short-term goals to players

90-Day Execution Roadmap

Phase	Weeks	Focus & Key Deliverables
Phase 1: Diagnose & Quick Wins	0–4	Build analytics dashboards for six funnels, fix server connection retry logic, add one-tap ammo restock and tutorials, show “Next Unlock” UI in HUD
Phase 2: Core Engagement Levers	5–10	Launch login reward A/B test, deploy missions with progress bars, roll out control presets, ship weapon progression previews
Phase 3: Scale & Monetization Gate	11–13	Analyze A/B results and roll out winner, enhance mission rewards, prepare social and faction meta, delay monetization experiments until KPIs met

Problem 3: Investigate Royal Match Drop-Offs (Levels 6-9)

Context & Why It Matters

We observed a sharp increase in player drop-off between levels 6-9.

DAU declined 12%, sessions shortened, and IAP conversions stalled.

Fixing this early engagement cliff is essential to boost monetization.





8-Pillar Deep-Dive Investigation

Historical Performance Check

Weekly level completion and session length analyzed.
Hypothesis: Drop-off linked to recent updates.

Design Change Audit

Review level targets, FTUE, and level layouts.
Hypothesis: Design changes increased difficulty.

Visual & UI Update Review

Analyzed tile art, boosters UI, and mis-tap rates. Hypothesis:
Visual clutter causes player frustration.

Move Economy Analysis

Compared allowed vs. used moves in levels.
Hypothesis: Tight tuning pushes players to quit.

Mechanics & Novelty Assessment

Cataloged new mechanics introduced.
Hypothesis: Lack of novelty causes gameplay boredom.

FTUE & Tutorial Coverage Audit

Checked mid-game tutorials, especially boosters and reshuffle.
Hypothesis: Onboarding to mechanics is weak.

Marketing Campaign Investigation

Audited new and paused ads, audience fit.
Hypothesis: Mismatched cohorts increase churn.

Demographic Segmentation Analysis

Analyzed drop-offs by age, gender, region, device.
Hypothesis: Certain segments struggle more.

Player Experience Improvements

After investigation, we hypothesize players drop off because the game feels tedious. "Tedious" can mean unclear objectives, difficult visual search, frustrating move economy, confusing tutorials, or lack of tool use. We will frame multiple hypotheses, each addressing a reason for tedium.

Hypothesis Area	Detailed Explanation	Solution	Detailed Solution
Objective Confusion	Players may not understand which tiles to clear quickly, causing wasted moves and early frustration.	Highlight Target Tiles	Use animated arrows and flashing borders at level start to instantly direct attention to target tiles, reducing confusion and wasted effort.
Visual Fatigue	Important tiles blending into backgrounds increase cognitive load, making board scanning slow and tiring. This happened with the grass tiles in Royal Match	Apply Subtle Glow to Target Tiles	Introduce a soft glowing outline around key tiles to gently stand out without crowding visuals, speeding player planning.
Tight Move Economy	Levels 6-9 often require near-perfect play, which demoralizes casual players and increases drop-offs.	Reduce Target Moves by 10%	Slightly lower move requirements by 10%, allowing more mistakes and boosting win rates without removing challenge.
Overwhelming FTUE	Excess mid-game tutorials interrupt flow and frustrate players attempting combos or strategies.	Disable Mid-Game Non-Critical Tutorials	Streamline onboarding by removing non-essential pop-ups, letting players enjoy gameplay without frequent interruptions.
Booster Unawareness	Players might not realize boosters exist or how to use them when stuck in levels.	Contextual Booster Tips	Add mid-level overlay tips triggered after few failed moves, nudging players to smartly use boosters like bombs.
Low Booster Usage	Players might want to save boosters for the later levels.	Offer First Booster Free After First Failure	After first failure, grant a free booster for the next try to demonstrate its impact and improve retry success.



Monetization Improvements

1. Our current primary issue is early gameplay churn between levels 6–9.
2. Players drop off before deeply engaging with boosters, retries, or IAP bundles.
3. Trying monetization changes now risks unclear conversion causes:
 - a. Players haven't stayed long enough.
 - b. Players aren't invested enough.
 - c. The offer itself isn't compelling.
4. Pre-stabilizing retention, monetization tests will only muddy data quality.
5. Fix engagement and progression loops first; then add monetization layers.

Strategic Summary

A clear spike in drop-offs between Levels 6–9 drives falling DAU, shorter sessions, and stalled monetization.

Players report "tedious gameplay," caused by unclear objectives, visual fatigue, tight move economy, overwhelming tutorials, and poor booster awareness.

We proposed an 8-pillar framework blending gameplay analysis, marketing funnel review, and demographic segmentation.

Monetization changes are paused until retention improves, preserving clean data and accurate diagnosis.

Our tactical focus is on clear objectives, reducing fatigue, tuning move economy, simplifying tutorials, and boosting booster use.

After friction reduces and key engagement KPIs rebound, we will introduce milestone bundles, rewarded ads, and extra moves monetization.

This phased, player-first strategy builds a foundation for healthy engagement and sustainable long-term growth.